FRONT SEAT BELT BUCKLE (Continued)

WARNING: TO AVOID PERSONAL INJURY OR DEATH, DURING AND FOLLOWING ANY SEAT BELT OR CHILD RESTRAINT ANCHOR SERVICE, CAREFULLY INSPECT ALL SEAT BELTS, BUCKLES, MOUNTING HARDWARE, RETRACTORS, TETHER STRAPS, AND ANCHORS FOR PROPER INSTALLATION, OPERATION, OR DAMAGE. REPLACE ANY BELT THAT IS CUT, FRAYED, OR TORN. STRAIGHTEN ANY BELT THAT IS TWISTED. TIGHTEN ANY LOOSE FASTENERS. REPLACE ANY BELT THAT HAS A DAMAGED OR INOPERATIVE BUCKLE OR RETRACTOR. REPLACE ANY BELT THAT HAS A BENT OR DAMAGED LATCH PLATE OR ANCHOR PLATE. REPLACE ANY CHILD RESTRAINT ANCHOR OR THE UNIT TO WHICH THE ANCHOR IS INTEGRAL THAT HAS BEEN BENT OR DAMAGED. NEVER ATTEMPT TO REPAIR A SEAT BELT OR CHILD RESTRAINT COMPONENT. ALWAYS REPLACE DAMAGED OR FAULTY SEAT BELT AND CHILD RESTRAINT COMPONENTS WITH THE CORRECT, NEW AND UNUSED REPLACEMENT PARTS LISTED IN THE DAIMLERCHRYSLER MOPAR PARTS CATALOG.

(1) Position the front seat belt buckle lower anchor to the bracket on the rear of the upper inner front seat track.

(2) Install and tighten the screw that secures the front seat belt buckle lower anchor to the front seat track bracket (Fig. 30). Tighten the screw to 43 N·m (32 ft. lbs.).

(3) On the driver side only, reconnect the seat belt switch pigtail wire connector to the body wire harness connector for the seat belt switch (Fig. 29).

PASSENGER AIRBAG

DESCRIPTION

The rearward facing surface of the injection molded, thermoplastic passenger airbag door is the most visible part of the passenger airbag (Fig. 31). The passenger airbag door is located above the glove box opening on the instrument panel in front of the front seat passenger seating position. The passenger airbag door also serves as a trim cover and has two flanges and a stamped metal bracket that secure it to the instrument panel structural support. The upper flange is secured with screws to the top of the instrument panel structural support and the lower flange to the upper glove box opening reinforcement. A stamped metal passenger airbag door hinge bracket is secured to the back of the instrument panel structural support with two screws.

Located behind the passenger airbag door within the instrument panel is the passenger airbag unit. The passenger airbag unit has an upper rear bracket and a lower rear bracket that are secured by nuts to three weld studs on the instrument panel structural support, one stud at the top and two at the bottom. Two nuts secure a front lower bracket on the passenger airbag housing to two weld studs on the dash panel above the heater and air conditioner housing. The front lower bracket mounts are accessed through the instrument panel glove box opening.

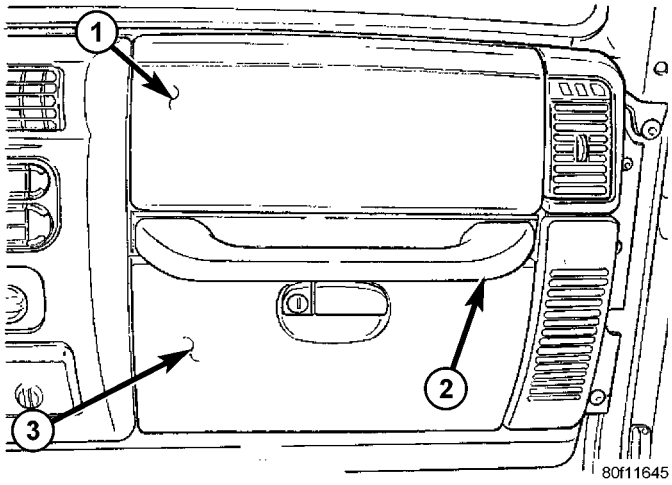

Fig. 31 Passenger Airbag Door

1 - PASSENGER AIRBAG DOOR
2 - GRAB HANDLE
3 - GLOVE BOX DOOR

The passenger airbag unit used in this model is a Next Generation-type that complies with revised federal airbag standards to deploy with less force than those used in some prior models. The passenger airbag unit consists of a stamped and welded metal housing or retainer, the airbag cushion, and the airbag inflator. The airbag housing contains the airbag inflator and the folded airbag cushion. A rectangular fabric cushion is used. The airbag inflator is a hybrid-type unit that is secured to and sealed within the stamped metal airbag housing beneath the folded airbag cushion. The inflator initiator is connected to the vehicle electrical system through a yellow connector on the end of a short, two-wire pigtail harness and a take out of the body wire harness.

The passenger airbag and the passenger airbag door are available as separate service items. The passenger airbag cannot be repaired, and must be replaced if deployed, faulty, or in any way damaged. The passenger airbag door will be damaged and must be replaced following an airbag deployment.

OPERATION

The passenger airbag is deployed by an electrical signal generated by the Airbag Control Module (ACM) through the passenger airbag squib circuits to the initiator in the airbag inflator. The hybrid-type inflator assembly includes a small canister of highly